didn’t cause you any trouble with your landlady. She wasn’t happy that I came asking for you. She demanded I give her my name, but I wouldn’t. She’s not very friendly, is she?”

“She’s always like that, insisting men shouldn’t call at the boardinghouse. Don’t worry—I’m used to her.”

The sound of footfalls and men’s voices came from across the square, drawing their attention. Two French gendarmes, tall and imposing in their blue uniforms, entered Place Martroi.

“Look, Rose, I must go,” he said, stepping away from her. “Tomorrow, we could meet at Quai du Roi. Same time.” He raked his fingers through his hair, revealing a slight scar on his forehead. “Bring your sketchbook.”

Rose glanced at the gendarmes, their heavy boots echoing on the cobblestones. “I’d love to,” she said, turning back. But André had already gone.